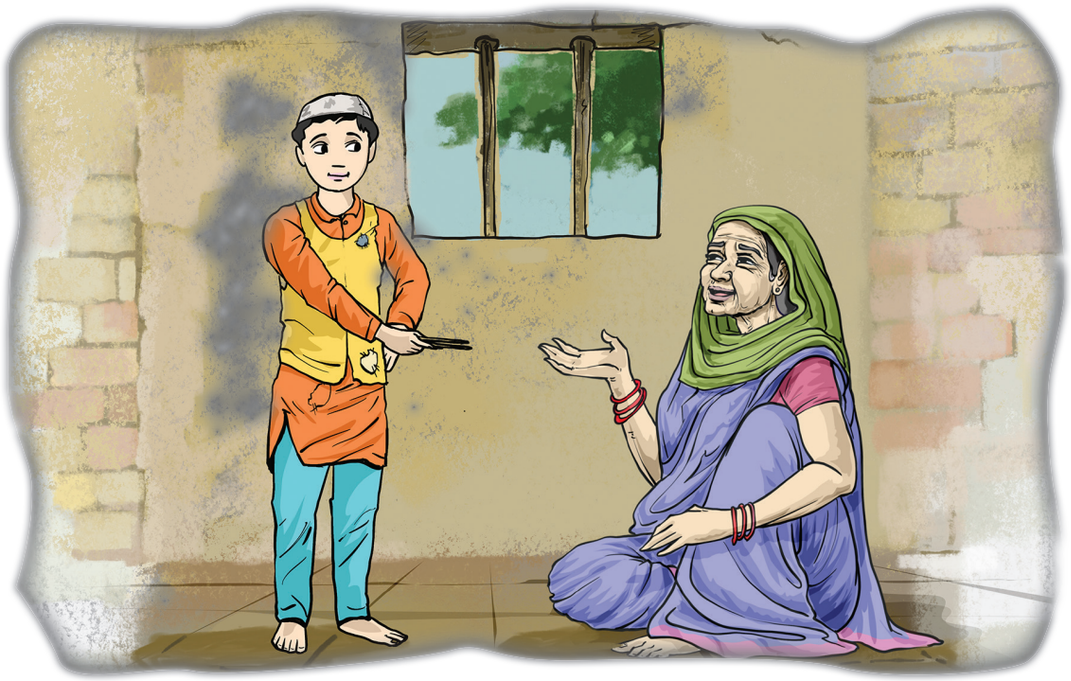
Section - I

READING



How wonderful and beautiful was the morning of Eid! The trees looked greener, the field more festive, the sky had a lovely pink glow. The sun seemed brighter and more **dazzling** than before to wish the world a very happy Eid.

The village was filled with excitement. Everyone was up early to go to the Eidgah. The boys were more excited than the others. They had been talking about it all the time. Finally the day had come. And now they were impatient. They were taking their treasure out of their pockets, counting and recounting it before putting it back. Mahmood counted "One, two, ten, twelve"– he had twelve coins. Mohsin had "One, two, three, eight, nine, fifteen" coins. With this money, they would buy countless things: toys, sweets, paper-pipes, rubber balls – and much more.

The happiest of the boys was Hamid. He was only four, thin and poorly dressed. Last year his father had died of cholera. Then his mother also died. From then Hamid lived with his old Granny Ameena and was as happy as a lark. She told him that his father had gone to earn money. And that his mother had gone to Allah to get lovely gifts for him. This made Hamid very happy. Hamid had no shoes on his feet; the cap on his

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